County of Santa Clara Registrar of Voters

BALLOT MEASURE PRIMARY ARGUMENT FORM

This **Ballot Measure Primary Argument Form** must be submitted **for all ballot measure PRIMARY ARGUMENTS**, with required signatures and author information. The County of Santa Clara Office of the Registrar of Voters allows electronic submission of documents if the scanned copy is clear and readable. You may email your completed form and attach the primary argument in Microsoft Word version to candidateservices@rov.sccgov.org. Any errors submitted on the form or primary argument will be printed in the County Voter Information Guide and/or ballot exactly as submitted. A proof will be sent to the primary filer for confirmation that it matches the argument as submitted—no other corrections will be accepted.

Assembly Bill 1416 was signed by the Governor and is effective as of January 1, 2023. This legislation (Elections Code section 9170) allows primary argument signers to provide a list of individuals, associations, nonprofit organizations, or businesses that are signers or are listed within the text of the argument who support or oppose a ballot measure to be listed under the ballot label. If you wish to submit a list of supporters or opponents, please complete Section 4 on page 5 of this form by providing a list of names of the individuals, associations, nonprofit organizations, and/or businesses to be listed as supporters or opponents. A sample ballot label is provided on page 9, Section 6: Appendix C.

Office Use Only

FILED

AUG 11 2026

REGISTRAR OF VOTERS
COUNTY OF SANTA CLARA
By [redacted] Deputy

Time/Date Stamp

Date of Election: November 3, 2026 General Election
Jurisdiction: Gilroy Unified School District

Primary Argument due date (E-84): August 11, 2026
Examination Period (E-83 to E-74): August 12, 2026 to August 21, 2026

Rebuttal Argument due date (E-77): August 18, 2026
Examination Period (E-76 to E-67): August 19, 2026 to August 28, 2026

Measure Letter M_____ (if available – letters will be assigned after 5:00 p.m. on E-88)

Type Arg you ing

☐ Primary Argument in Favor / Proponent

☑ Primary Argument Against / Opponent

Declaration Related to Proponent/Opponent Primary Arguments
(Elections Code §§ 9161, 9164, 9167, 9170, 9501, 9501.5, 9504, 9600)

Appl

☐ **I am an Author of the Proponent Primary Argument** (noted above) for **Measure** _____ being submitted. I support this measure.

☑ **I am an Author of the Opponent Primary Argument** (noted above) for **Measure** M_____ being submitted. I oppose this measure.

FILER / SIGNER SECTION

The Filer of a Primary Argument is the person or entity that is responsible for filing an argument for or against (or in rebuttal to an argument for or against) a measure. The Signer of the Primary Argument is a person whose name is listed and published in the County Voter Information Guide in the election materials after the argument as one of the signatories. Generally, a Filer or Signer may be a district or member(s) of the governing board of that district, an individual voter who is eligible to vote on the measure, a bona fide association of citizens, or a combination of such voters and associations. The Filer signs the argument submission form, attesting under penalty of perjury that they meet the requirements to file an argument. The Filer is typically the main proponent or opponent of the measure but does not have to be. A Filer can also be a Signer of the argument. State law allows for up to five signers for any argument. Therefore, five people may be both Filers and Signers. However, Filers are not required to be Signers.

NOTE: Personal contact information including street address, phone and email will be redacted prior to posting online. Do not include personal contact information when using business information as it is not redacted prior to posting online.

FILL OUT BOTH FILER AND SIGNER SECTIONS IF YOU ARE A FILER AND A SIGNER OF THE PRIMARY ARGUMENT

*** Required information.**

I am the **FILER** of the primary argument: ☑ Yes / ☐ No

I am also a **SIGNER** of the primary argument: ☑ Yes / ☐ No

AS A FILER: My contact information for receiving the opposing author's primary argument is:

*** My Name is:** Mark W.A. Hinkle

INDICATE IF ADDRESS IS: ☑ **Residential or Residential Mailing;** ☐ **Business or Business Mailing**

* Address: [redacted] Morgan Hill CA 95037

* Email Address: [redacted] Phone Number (cell/direct): [redacted]

DO NOT FILL OUT BELOW SIGNER SECTION IF YOU ARE A FILER ONLY OF THE PRIMARY ARGUMENT

AS A SIGNER: I am a: ☐ Registered Voter in the District ☐ Governing Board Member ☑ * Principal Officer of an Organization

*** I have attached one of the following items listed on Page 2 to this form.**

*** My GENDER is:**

☑ Masculine ☐ Feminine ☐ Androgynous or Non-binary ☐ Other: _____

*** My SIGNING ORDER** on the Argument text to be published is: ☑ 1 / ☐ 2 / ☐ 3 / ☐ 4 / ☐ 5 *(please check one)*

*** My name as a SIGNER** (signature to be printed with the primary argument) is: Mark W.A. Hinkle
(do not include degrees or titles; print or type signature in upper- and lower-case font)

*** TITLE OF SIGNER** (to be printed with the primary argument) is: President: Silicon Valley Taxpayers Association
(limited to one title only; do not include descriptors; print or type title in upper- and lower-case font)

SIGNATURE ➡

Under penalty of perjury, I attest the above information meets the required criteria for an individual or for an organization or bona fide association of citizens for purposes of submitting an argument:

[redacted]

ROV ONLY ACCEPTS WET OR DOCUSIGNED SIGNATURES (signatures will be redacted prior to posting online)

[argument starts here]

6

Stop this huge new tax hike!

16

The Gilroy Unified School District is asking you to approve Measure M to incur bond debt of $295 million.

18

That's an IOU to Wall Street bankers that you'd have to repay—**through your taxes**—for around 30 YEARS.

4

Have they earned it?

The stats:

- Drop in ADA enrollment since 2020-21 school year = 387 students.
- Percentage of students **behind grade level in English = 59.77%**
- Percentage **behind grade level in math = 67.58%**
- Chronic absenteeism data = 21%
- Cohort graduates meeting the UC/CSU course requirements = 50.9%
- Teachers' salaries of $85,611 (2020-21) rose to $106,112 (2024-25)
    - An increase of $20,501

54

Education Data Partnership* shows enrollment of only 10,777 students in the district, so the bond debt could exceed $27,373 per student — NOT COUNTING **interest expense**, which usually ***doubles the cost.***

29

Would that do **anything** to help the children?

8

When you buy a home, truth-in-lending laws require that you be told the real, total cost of purchasing that home. For example:

24

- Borrowing $295,000,000; paying 3% interest for 30 years would incur interest expenses of approximately $153,000,000, plus principal, $295,000,000, for a lifetime total cost of $447,000,000 ... of YOUR money!

27

Consumer protection laws should apply to bond issues. As taxpayers, we deserve to know the full truth about Measure M. We don't even know when this debt will begin, let alone what the market interest rate will be, when it does.

41

Just say NO to bond debt.

6

Questions:

- Will this bond-debt tax hike reverse declining English proficiency?

11

- Will this bond-debt tax hike reverse declining math proficiency?
- Will this bond-debt tax hike fix declining enrollment?
- Will this bond-debt tax hike fix chronic absenteeism?

Stop rewarding bad behavior.

Vote *NO* on bond-debt tax increases!

For more information: *SVTaxpayers.org*

* *Ed-Data.org*

[argument ends here]